

Newsletter

Dear Parents, Guardians and Staff,



As winter settles in and the final weeks of the term unfold, we find ourselves in a season that offers an important reminder: growth often happens quietly before it becomes visible. The trees may appear bare, the mornings colder, and the days shorter, yet beneath the surface, nature is preparing for renewal. In much the same way, our learners are currently engaged in one of the most significant periods of the academic year—the examination season. While the results of their hard work may not yet be visible, every hour spent studying, every lesson revised, every mistake corrected, and every challenge overcome is contributing to future success.

As author James Clear reminds us, "Every action you take is a vote for the person you wish to become."

Throughout this term, our Exam Preparation Focus Series has highlighted the importance of preparing with purpose. From targeted revision and the effective use of feedback, to managing stress, maintaining healthy routines, and taking ownership of learning, we continue to encourage learners to approach their examinations with both discipline and balance.

Research consistently shows that academic success is not determined solely by intelligence, but by habits. Learners who set goals, seek support when needed, review feedback, and establish consistent routines are far more likely to achieve positive outcomes than those who rely on last-minute preparation. Success, after all, is rarely accidental.

Equally important is wellbeing. Examination periods can be demanding, particularly for teenagers navigating academic expectations alongside the many challenges of adolescence. The pressure to perform can feel overwhelming at times, which is why we continue to emphasise the importance of sleep, nutrition, exercise, and open communication. A healthy mind and body remain among the most powerful tools any learner can take into an examination room.

As we encourage academic excellence, we also celebrate the many opportunities that continue to enrich learning beyond the classroom. This edition showcases our learners' participation in academic Olympiads, practical assessments, sporting achievements, leadership opportunities, and career exposure initiatives. Whether competing on the sports field, completing a Consumer Studies practical assessment, or preparing for a professional job-shadowing experience, our learners continue to develop skills that extend far beyond textbooks and examinations.

We are also reminded of the importance of compassion and community. Next term's Nelson Mandela Day outreach initiative, our Jars of Hope campaign, provides an opportunity for learners to contribute to something greater than themselves. In a world often focused on individual achievement, giving back remains one of the greatest lessons we can teach. As Nelson Mandela famously said,

"What counts in life is not the mere fact that we have lived. It is what difference we have made to the lives of others."



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To our learners: continue to focus on your own journey. Do not measure your progress against that of others. Your greatest competition is the person you were yesterday. Stay committed to your goals, trust the process, and remember that every small step forward matters.

To our parents and guardians: thank you for your continued partnership, encouragement, and support. The role you play in your child's education remains invaluable.

To our staff: thank you for the dedication, care, and commitment you demonstrate each day in supporting our learners academically, emotionally, and personally.

As we move through this winter season, may we embrace the lessons it offers—patience, resilience, preparation, and hope. The work being done today is laying the foundation for the successes of tomorrow.

Wishing all our learners focus, confidence, and success as they continue their examinations.

Kind regards,
Ms Aishah Kader

Welcoming Our New FET Phase Head - Mr Juan-Pierre Oosthuizen



It is with great pleasure that we welcome Mr JP Oosthuizen to the Curro Clayville family as our newly appointed FET Phase Head. Mr Oosthuizen brings with him over 11 years of educational experience, having taught and led in a variety of schools both within South Africa and internationally. His extensive experience, passion for education, and commitment to learner development make him a valuable addition to our leadership team.

Academically, Mr Oosthuizen holds a Bachelor of Education in Mathematics and Engineering Graphics and Design from North-West University, as well as a Bachelor of Education Honours in Educational Leadership. Throughout his career, he has taught a wide range of subjects including Engineering Graphics and Design, Mathematics, Technology, Life Orientation, and Natural Sciences.

His leadership journey has seen him serve in various positions, including Head of Grade, Head of STEM, Head of Department, and FET Phase Head. These experiences have equipped him with a strong understanding of both academic excellence and learner support. Mr Oosthuizen is particularly passionate about creating meaningful learning experiences that inspire curiosity, innovation, and personal growth. His educational philosophy focuses on developing the whole learner by balancing academic achievement with strong values, leadership opportunities,



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and practical real-world skills. He also has a keen interest in STEM education, robotics, and preparing learners for the rapidly evolving world beyond the classroom.

As he joins our community, Mr Oosthuizen looks forward to building strong partnerships with learners, parents, and staff, creating an environment where every learner feels supported, challenged, and empowered to reach their full potential. We are excited to have him on board and look forward to the positive impact he will make within our High School and broader school community.

At the same time, we would like to extend our sincere gratitude to Mr Bunhu, who has served as Acting FET Phase Head since last year. His dedication, leadership, and commitment during this period have been greatly appreciated, and we thank him for the invaluable contribution he has made to the continued growth and success of the High School. While Mr Oosthuizen now assumes responsibility as FET Phase Head, Mr Bunhu will continue to play an important role within the High School, overseeing key areas and supporting our learners and staff in various capacities.

Please join us in extending a warm Curro Clayville welcome to Mr Oosthuizen as he begins this exciting new chapter with us.

"Leadership is not about being in charge. It is about taking care of those in your charge." — Simon Sinek

Exam Preparation Focus Series: Accountability and Learner Ownership

As we continue our examination preparation journey, one of the most important lessons we can teach our learners extends far beyond the examination room. It is the lesson of accountability.

At Curro Clayville, learners are encouraged to take ownership of their academic journey by setting goals, tracking their progress, identifying areas for improvement, and seeking assistance when needed. These are not only essential examination skills but life skills that will serve them throughout their academic and professional careers.

One of the unique aspects of our reporting process is that learners set their own personal academic goals. These goals are based on their abilities, aspirations, and understanding of their own potential. After all, who knows a learner's capabilities better than the learner themselves?

Goal setting creates ownership. Ownership creates accountability. When report results are released, we engage in accountability discussions with teachers. During these conversations, teachers provide feedback on the interventions, support strategies, extra classes, consultations, and resources that were made available to assist learners. Once we have established the support provided, we then ask learners an important question: *"What did you do with the opportunities that were given to you?"*

This is not about blame. It is about helping learners understand that success is a shared responsibility. Schools can provide resources. Teachers can provide support. Parents can provide encouragement. But ultimately, learners must choose to engage, participate, and take ownership of their own learning. Research consistently shows that learners who take responsibility for setting goals, monitoring their progress, and reflecting on their performance achieve higher academic outcomes than those who remain passive participants in their education. These learners develop what psychologists refer to as "self-regulated learning" — the ability to manage their own learning process effectively.



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Unfortunately, one of the greatest challenges facing learners today is distraction. Many spend hours watching others live their lives through social media, following influencers, trends, and content that often adds little value to their own goals. As Jim Rohn famously said:

"You cannot change your destination overnight, but you can change your direction overnight."

Every hour spent scrolling is an hour that could have been invested in building a future. The reality is that no influencer, content creator, or celebrity can study for an examination on a learner's behalf. The most successful learners are not necessarily the most talented. They are often the ones who consistently choose discipline over distraction. This becomes even more important when learners move on to tertiary education. Universities offer incredible opportunities, but they also demand independence. Lecturers will not always follow up on missed work. Nobody will remind students to study. Nobody will monitor their daily progress. In many ways, learners become responsible for managing their own academic success. High school is where these habits should begin. Learners are encouraged to learn to:

- Ask questions when they do not understand.
- Seek help before problems become crises.
- Find additional resources when needed.
- Manage their own time effectively.
- Reflect honestly on their performance.
- Take responsibility for both successes and setbacks.
-

As John C. Maxwell reminds us: *"The greatest day in your life and mine is when we take total responsibility for our attitudes. That's the day we truly grow up."*

The weeks ahead present an opportunity for every learner to take ownership of their preparation. Set your goals. Create a plan. Use the resources available to you. Ask for help when needed. Most importantly, hold yourself accountable to the future you want to create. Because at the end of the day, your results will not be determined by your intentions, but by your actions.

"Success is not owned. It is rented, and the rent is due every day." — Rory Vaden

The Curro Learning Portal

The Curro Learning Portal serves as our secure digital learning platform. It is where learners access course content, submit assignments, participate in discussions, and receive structured feedback from teachers. The platform also enables educators to track learner progress and adjust teaching strategies to ensure every learner is supported appropriately.

We are confident that this integrated approach will continue to enhance the academic experience of our learners at Curro Clayville High School. For parents who would like to gain a deeper understanding of how Blended Learning works within the Curro environment, we encourage you to view the informative video shared below.

[Blended Learning at Curro: A Smarter Way to Learn](#)

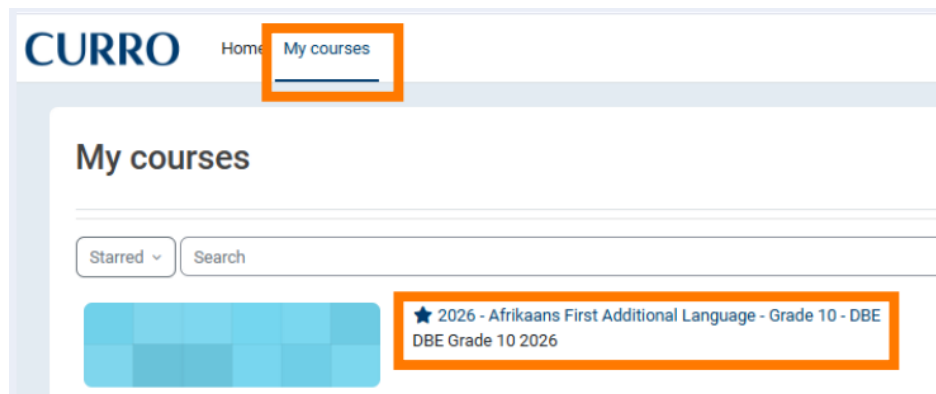
Together, we continue to build a learning environment that is innovative, supportive, and focused on the success of every learner.



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Learners can use the following link to log on to their profiles with their Curro Login information as shown below.

<https://digital.curro.co.za/login/index.php>



Study Resources and Past Examination Papers

<https://www.testpapers.co.za/>

<https://www.ecexams.co.za/ExaminationPapers.htm>

<https://wcedportal.co.za/resources-to-support-grade-8-learning-and-teaching>

Teaching Plans: <https://www.education.gov.za/Curriculum/NationalCurriculumStatementsGradesR-12/2023ATPsSP.aspx>

Grade 12 Exam Guidelines: <https://www.education.gov.za/2021Grade12ExamGuidelines.aspx>

Learner Resources: <https://www.education.gov.za/Informationfor/Learners.aspx>

NSC May-June 2025: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1BcG1bKmFGH-tMYxFf4tEZmcFZnO38Ppp?usp=drive_link





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Mid-Year Examination Processes



As the mid-year examinations commence, we would like to outline the key processes and protocols to ensure that learners are well prepared and that examinations run smoothly.

Pre-Examination Briefings

Before each examination, teachers will conduct a short briefing in the classroom. During this time, examination rules and regulations will be read and clarified for learners to ensure a clear understanding of expectations.

Learner Attendance During Exams

Learners who are not scheduled to write on a specific day are allowed to remain at home. However, should a learner attend school on a non-writing day, they will not be permitted to loiter. Instead, they will be allocated to a supervised venue where they are expected to use the time productively for examination preparation. Learners should therefore bring relevant study material with them.

Post-Examination Supervision

Once learners have completed their examination, they are expected to leave the school premises. A 30-minute grace period will be allowed for collection. Learners still on site after this time will be supervised in a designated venue until 14h30, under the supervision of teachers on duty.

Arrival Times

All learners must arrive at school by **07h30** daily. Those writing only in the second session should arrive by **11h00**, with afternoon examination sessions commencing at **13h00**. Learners who arrive earlier than their scheduled session will be provided with a study venue to ensure their time is used productively.

Dismissal Times and Learner Safety

From the **27th of May**, dismissal will take place at **12h00**. For safety reasons, learners are not allowed to wait outside the school premises and must remain on site at all times.

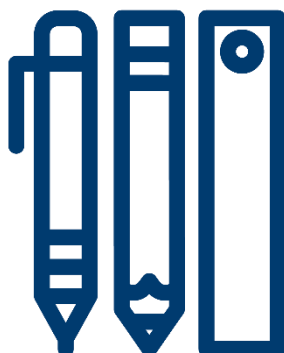
Teachers on Duty will remain on site until 12h30. Thereafter, learners will be allocated to supervised classrooms for study preparation until 14h30. This arrangement applies on days where no afternoon examination session is scheduled.

Should learners need to wait for transport collection, parents are kindly requested to ensure that learners bring along sufficient study material so that they may use this time productively and prepare effectively for upcoming examinations.

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Monday, 08 June 2026	09:00	NATURAL SCIENCES	1,5 Hours	MATHEMATICS	2 Hours
Tuesday, 09 June 2026	09:00	GEOGRAPHY	1,5 Hours	AFRIKAANS	2 Hours
	14:00	CHOICE FAL 12:00 - 14:00	2 Hours		
Wednesday, 10 June 2026	09:00	EMS P2	1 Hour	LIFE ORIENTATION	1,5 Hours
	12:30	CODING & ROBOTICS	1 Hour		
Thursday, 11 June 2026	09:00	HISTORY	2 Hours	EMS P2	1 Hour
Friday, 12 June 2026	09:00	CREATIVE ARTS	1,5 Hours	GEOGRAPHY	1,5 Hours
	12:30				
Monday, 15 June 2026	SCHOOL HOLIDAY				
Tuesday, 16 June 2026	YOUTH DAY				
Wednesday, 17 June 2026	09:00				
Thursday, 18 June 2026	09:00			CODING & ROBOTICS	1 Hour
Friday, 19 June 2026	09:00				

Monday, 08 June 2026	09:00	ACCOUNTING	2,5 Hours	LIFE SCIENCES	2,5 Hours	MATH P2 MATH LITERACY P2	3 Hours	2 Hours
Tuesday, 09 June 2026	09:00	BUSINESS STUDIES P1	2 Hours	BUSINESS STUDIES P2	2 Hours			
	14:00					HISTORY P2	3 Hours	
Wednesday, 10 June 2026	09:00	PHYSICAL SCIENCES	2 Hours	CAT P2	2,5 Hours			
	12:30							
Thursday, 11 June 2026	09:00	HISTORY	2 Hours	CAT P1	2,5 Hours	BUSINESS STUDIES P2	2 Hours	
Friday, 12 June 2026	09:00	BUSINESS STUDIES P2	2 Hours	ACCOUNTING P2	2 Hours	PHYSICAL SCIENCES P1	3 Hours	
	12:30	CHOICE FAL P1	2 Hours					
Monday, 15 June 2026	SCHOOL HOLIDAY							
Tuesday, 16 June 2026	YOUTH DAY							
Wednesday, 17 June 2026	09:00			PHYSICAL SCIENCES P2	1 Hour	PHYSICAL SCIENCES P2	3 Hours	
Thursday, 18 June 2026	09:00					ECONOMICS P2	2 Hours	
Friday, 19 June 2026	09:00			CONSUMER STUDIES	2,5 Hours	LIFE ORIENTATION 14:00 -16:00	2 Hours	
Monday, 22 June 2026	09:00					LIFE SCIENCES	2,5 Hours	
Tuesday, 23 June 2026	09:00					ENGLISH P3	3 Hours	
Wednesday, 24 June 2026	09:00					AFRIKAANS P3 ISIZULU P3	2,5 Hours	
Thursday, 25 June 2026	09:00							
Friday, 26 June 2026	09:00							
GRADE 12 PROVINCIAL SET PAPER		GRADE 12 DISTRICT SET						





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Consumer Studies: More Than Just Cooking

Over the last two weeks of May, our Consumer Studies learners completed their Practical Assessment Task (PAT), an important component of the subject that contributes 25% of their term mark. While many people associate Consumer Studies solely with cooking, the practical assessment represents only one aspect of a dynamic and multidisciplinary subject that prepares learners for a wide range of careers and real-world challenges. Consumer Studies is a field of study that focuses on the wellbeing of consumers and their interactions with communities, businesses, and the environment. It equips learners with knowledge and skills that are invaluable for life, empowering them to become informed, responsible consumers while fostering creativity, innovation, and entrepreneurship. The subject combines elements of:

- Food and Nutrition
- Clothing and Fashion
- Housing and Interior Design
- Consumer Behaviour
- Business Principles
- Tourism Management
- Entrepreneurship

This means that Consumer Studies sits at the intersection of several disciplines and serves as an excellent complementary subject for both Business Studies and Life Sciences. One of the greatest strengths of Consumer Studies is its strong entrepreneurial focus. Learners are taught how to identify consumer needs, develop products, calculate costs and profits, manage resources, and market products effectively. In essence, they learn how to transform an idea into a viable business opportunity. As Peter Drucker once said:

"The best way to predict the future is to create it."

The practical component provides learners with an opportunity to apply theory in meaningful ways, but behind every successful practical assessment lies careful planning, budgeting, costing, mathematical calculations, research, time management, and problem-solving. Consumer Studies is also one of the few subjects that develops both academic knowledge and practical life skills simultaneously. Learners gain valuable insight into nutrition, sustainable living, ethical consumer choices, financial decision-making, and resource management—skills that remain relevant long after school. The broad nature of the syllabus means that Consumer Studies supports a wide variety of tertiary studies and career pathways across the humanities, commerce, and science faculties. Learners who choose this subject often keep multiple career options open while developing versatile and highly transferable skills. Career opportunities include:

- Entrepreneur
- Product Developer and Manufacturer
- Events Coordinator
- Dietician
- Clothing Designer or Fashion Buyer
- Interior Designer
- Housing Consultant
- Chef
- Hotel Manager
- Food Stylist or Food Writer
- Retail Product Developer
- Merchandiser
- Marketing Specialist
- Consumer Behaviour Consultant



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Many of these careers also offer significant earning potential. Professionals in fields such as dietetics, interior design, hospitality management, product development, marketing, and entrepreneurship can build highly successful careers, particularly when combined with tertiary qualifications and industry experience. Entrepreneurs who identify and successfully meet consumer needs have the potential to create businesses that generate employment and economic growth. Beyond career opportunities, Consumer Studies teaches learners how to think critically, make informed decisions, and navigate an increasingly complex consumer world. In a society where individuals are constantly faced with choices regarding finances, health, sustainability, and consumption, these skills are more valuable than ever.

We congratulate our Consumer Studies learners on the completion of their Practical Assessment Tasks and commend them for the hard work, dedication, and creativity they demonstrated throughout the process. Their practical assessments showcased not only technical skills but also the planning, perseverance, and entrepreneurial thinking that lie at the heart of this exciting subject. As Steve Jobs famously noted:

"Innovation distinguishes between a leader and a follower."

Consumer Studies continues to provide our learners with opportunities to innovate, create, and prepare for a future filled with possibilities.





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Creative Corner: Creativity Shines Through Curro Create

Curro Clayville learners recently showcased their creativity and talent through their submissions for Curro Create. Learners submitted a wide range of creative pieces including photographs, stories, poems, presentations, and various other artistic works that reflected both originality and passion.

We are incredibly proud of every learner who participated and commend them for their courage to share their creativity beyond the classroom.

Creative platforms such as Curro Create provide learners with the opportunity to express themselves, develop confidence, and refine important skills such as communication, critical thinking, and innovation. Participation in these initiatives also encourages learners to explore their individual talents and passions.

This week, we proudly feature a poem written by Lesego Motubatse in Grade 9 — a top achiever and an active member of our Newsletter Committee and Innovation Circle. Lesego continues to demonstrate both academic excellence and remarkable creativity, and we are excited to showcase this piece as part of our Curro Create journey.

A legacy boundless

By Lesego Motubatse

In chains of iron, bound and torn,
A story deep with pain is born,
Beneath the sun's relentless glare,
They bore a weight too hard to bear.

Fields stretched wide, a sea of toil,
Sweat and blood soaked the soil,
Hands that built with strength and grace,
Yet wore the scars no time could erase.

Voices silenced, spirits bruised,
Dreams deferred, hopes abused,
But in the darkest night they found
A flame within, a sacred sound.

Songs of sorrow, songs of fight,
Whispered prayers for coming light,
Through lashes sharp and hearts oppressed,
A yearning soul refused to rest.

Families shattered, lives displaced,
But courage held, a steady pace,
In every tear and every scar, A
testament to who they are.

Not broken, though the world
might see A people longing to be
free, From chains of hate, from
cruel control, They fought to
claim their very soul.

So let us honor, let us tell, The
stories where their spirits dwell,
For in their struggle, strength was
sown, A legacy that's ours to own.





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Opening Doors to the Professional World

Earlier this year, we shared exciting news about our partnership with PKF Octagon and the opportunity it would provide for our learners through a dedicated Job Shadowing Programme. Today, we are delighted to share an exciting update with our school community. After a competitive application process, nine Curro Clayville learners have been selected to represent our school in the Job Shadowing Programme taking place from 1 to 3 July 2026. This opportunity reflects not only the academic capabilities of our learners but also their ambition, professionalism, and willingness to invest in their future careers. We are incredibly proud of each learner who applied and extend our congratulations to those who were selected.

The programme will provide learners with invaluable exposure to the professional world, allowing them to engage directly with industry professionals and gain first-hand insight into various career pathways. During the three-day experience, learners will have the opportunity to shadow professionals within departments such as Tax, Auditing, Company Secretarial, and Accounting, gaining practical exposure to workplace expectations and the realities of the corporate environment.

Experiences such as these play an important role in helping learners make informed subject and career choices while developing a deeper understanding of the skills, work ethic, and professionalism required in the world beyond school. As the saying goes, *“The future depends on what you do today.”* — Mahatma Gandhi

Career exposure programmes bridge the gap between education and industry, allowing learners to see how the knowledge and skills they acquire in the classroom translate into real-world opportunities. They also encourage learners to begin thinking critically about their future aspirations and the pathways needed to achieve them.

We are excited to see our learners represent Curro Clayville and make the most of this incredible opportunity. We know they will be outstanding ambassadors for our school and will return with valuable insights that can inspire their peers. Further details regarding logistics and arrangements will be communicated as soon as they are finalised. We look forward to sharing their experiences and celebrating their achievements when they return from what promises to be an enriching and memorable experience.



From Left to Right: Bafana Hlolani, Alicia Ndlovu, Kgotso Ramphefa, Anotida Bunhu, Katlego Mashao and Keoikantse Phokobye



From Left to Right: Anotida Bunhu, Mokgethi Mokgathlane (Head Boy) and Phomello Mphotwana (Deputy Head Boy)



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Jars of Hope: Small Acts, Big Impact



As we prepare for our Nelson Mandela Day Outreach Project next term, we invite our Curro Clayville community to join us in a meaningful initiative that embodies the spirit of giving back and making a difference.

We are excited to launch our Jars of Hope Campaign, and we need your help!

We are currently collecting clean glass coffee jars with lids, which will be used to create "Jars of Hope" for individuals and families in need. These jars will be filled with essential food items and thoughtful necessities, transforming an ordinary household item into a symbol of kindness, hope, and community support. If you have any clean glass coffee jars at home that you would be willing to donate, please send them to school with your child. Collections will continue until the end of term.

When learners return to school, on Thursday, 23 July 2026, they will come together as part of our Nelson Mandela Day initiative to spend 67 minutes giving back. During this time, learners will work collaboratively to fill the jars and prepare them for distribution to members of the community who may be facing difficult circumstances.

Nelson Mandela Day reminds us that every person has the power to make a positive difference. The concept of dedicating 67 minutes to service represents the 67 years that Nelson Mandela spent fighting for social justice, equality, and human dignity.

As Mandela famously said: "It is in your hands to create a better world for all who live in it."

The Jars of Hope project is about more than food or donations. It is about teaching our learners the importance of compassion, empathy, and social responsibility. It is about helping them understand that even small acts of kindness can have a lasting impact on someone's life. In a world that often focuses on what we can gain, Nelson Mandela Day encourages us to focus on what we can give. Whether it is our time, resources, talents, or kindness, every contribution matters.

As Anne Frank wisely observed: "No one has ever become poor by giving."

We encourage every family to participate in this initiative. A single donated jar may seem small, but together, hundreds of jars can become hundreds of messages of hope.

Thank you in advance for supporting this worthy cause and helping us teach our learners the value of paying it forward. We look forward to coming together as a school community to make a meaningful difference, one jar at a time.

"We rise by lifting others." — Robert Ingersoll



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In Closing



Grade 12 Mid Year Examination	20 May – 24 June
Grade 11 Mid Year Examination	20 May – 19 June
Grade 10 Mid Year Examination	20 May – 12 June
Grade 8 Mid Year Examination	29 May – 12 June
Grade 9 Mid Year Examination	29 May – 18 June
Grade 11 Leadership Camp	28 - 30 June
Grade 10 Camp	19 – 21 June
Octagon PKF Job Shadowing Programme	1 – 3 July

Thank you, parents, and guardians.
Your unwavering support, input and constant care is appreciated.



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